

Use Uncommon SSIDs

The second biggest mistake people make is to use their first names or surnames as their SSID. Think of an SSID like your ATM bank card PIN, or your email address password, this will help you create a decently un-guessable SSID.

Those setting up multiple networks, with more than one SSID need to take care to not set simple SSIDs and not use a simple variation of a single SSID. Security experts have often found homes and small offices using their names and company names as their SSID. Moreover, people have used the simplest variation of SSIDs over different floors. You need to think like a network intruder would: If a company is called XYZ Pvt. Ltd., and has offices on the third, fourth and fifth floor, the very first guesses of an unauthorised user would be "XYZ", "XYZ3", "XYZ4" and "XYZ5". Though this sounds silly in hindsight, many of us have been caught making this very simple mistake which puts our entire network at risk.

Don't Broadcast SSIDs

Wireless access points can be configured to stop broadcasting SSIDs, as is usually the case. This will help ensure that unauthorised users in the vicinity do not detect your SSID by default.

Of course, there are tools available that will still hack your SSID from the signals that are transmitted in your network, but turning off the broadcast of your SSID will stop novice hackers or rogue wireless devices from accessing your network.

Use IP/MAC Access Control

If your network consists of only a few devices, make sure to set your access point to limit access to only those devices. You can do this when configuring the access point. Either set it to acknowledge only a given IP, or range of IPs, or set it to allow access to only the specified MAC addresses. Each wireless device will have a card that has a unique MAC address. Find this address from your device and enter it into the access point's list of allowed devices.